

100 Days of Linux - Day 072

Title: Downloading Web Content with curl

Today's Goal

Learn how to retrieve data from websites and web servers using the curl command.

Why This Matters

Developers, Data Engineers and DevOps engineers frequently use curl to test APIs, download data and troubleshoot web services.

Command of the Day

Syntax: curl <URL>

Common options: -O (save file), -o (save with custom name), -I (headers only), -L (follow redirects).

Examples:

```
curl https://example.com
```

```
curl -I https://example.com
```

```
curl -O https://example.com/file.txt
```

Beginner Lesson

curl sends a request to a web server and displays the response in the terminal. It can also save files, inspect HTTP headers and download content from the internet.

Practice Questions

1. Display the homepage of <https://example.com>.
2. View only the HTTP headers of <https://example.com>.
3. Download a file using curl -O.
4. Save a webpage as homepage.html using -o.
5. Access a URL that redirects and follow the redirect using -L.

Hints

Use -I for headers, -O to keep the original filename, -o to choose your own filename and -L to follow redirects.

Mini Challenge

Download two web pages, save them with different filenames and verify they were created using ls.

Common Mistakes

Forgetting the URL, confusing -O with -o, or not using -L when a site redirects.

Did You Know?

Many REST APIs can be tested directly from the terminal using curl.

Pro Tip

Combine curl with pipes and files to automate data collection and API testing.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: curl https://example.com

Q2: curl -I https://example.com

Q3: curl -O https://example.com/file.txt

Q4: curl -o homepage.html https://example.com

Q5: curl -L http://example.com

Homework

Use curl to download three different web pages and save each with a meaningful filename.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you will learn how to download files using the wget command.